

Story Structure

Grade 5 Stories & Fables

Read the story. Then label each part with its plot stage.

The Lighthouse Light

Old Tomas had tended the lighthouse for forty years. Each evening he polished the great lamp until it shone like a second moon. One wild night a storm struck the coast. Wind howled and waves smashed the rocks. Suddenly the lamp went dark! The oil line had broken. Tomas grabbed a spare lantern and climbed the winding tower stairs. The wind shook the tower, but he kept climbing. At the top he lit the lantern and held it high in the lamp room. Its beam cut through the storm. Far below, a small ship turned away from the rocks. By morning the storm had passed. The sailors rowed ashore to thank Tomas. Your light saved our ship, they said. Tomas just smiled and began to polish the lamp again.

Label each part: I=introduction, P=problem, C=climax, F=falling action, R=resolution

_____ Tomas climbs the tower with a spare lantern.

_____ Old Tomas tends the lighthouse.

_____ The sailors thank Tomas the next morning.

_____ The lamp goes out during a storm.

_____ The light shines again and the ship turns away.